From an economic perspective, it would also be in the Western interest that India emerge more rapidly as a source of greater global demand and supply, thereby reducing excessive dependence on any single geography. This is going to be particularly important as we move to greater technology reliance. Given that resource and cost optimization will remain guiding principles of business, the salience of India's human resources to the global economy will only grow with time. Its market economy and responsible governance makes it a safe partner when it comes to contract designing and manufacturing.

For the West, there are also larger principles to prove in ensuring India's success. It will affirm that democratic politics and high growth economics are not mutually exclusive. India's multi-faith society is also an enormous contribution to global stability. In fact, that is what acts as a firewall preventing the spread of fundamentalism and radicalism from India's West to its East. But it also has its activist aspects that would be of growing value to a Western world. In areas like maritime security in the Indian Ocean or building connectivity in Asia, its contribution can make a difference. A willingness to shoulder greater HADR responsibility is already visible in the last few years. Its participation strengthens export control regimes dealing with sensitive technologies. And its presence not only adds to the credibility of various global initiatives and negotiations but often, as in the case of Paris on climate change, helps to find an outcome. For a Western system that must reinvent itself to stay strong, it is a good option to partner.

For all this to work, a number of important relationships need to come together in a self-supporting manner. These include India's ties with the US, the UK, Europe and Japan. When it comes to the US, it is noteworthy that India has solidified ties continuously with successive administrations in the recent past. The way forward has been to find a commonality that resonates: with Clinton, it was pluralism and business; with Bush, it was democracy and global strategy; and with Obama, climate change and radicalization. Following Trump's election, it is bilateralism, trade and security convergences. It is to India's advantage that an American President is less a prisoner of those regimes and orthodoxies that have long blocked progress with a newer partner. In the Trump vision of the world, allies have